where it is going is called as Random Access Memory.

As like the calculator, the computer is also having RAM. After the computer got ready whatever be the thing that we are giving, it should go to a memory and that particular memory is RAM. But, it will lose or the content of this memory will get erased when the computer is switched OFF or due to power failure. Hence, it is called as temporary memory or volatile memory. But it is live memory.



Without the concern of the RAM nothing can be done in the computer

If we are seeing something on the monitor, it is understand that, it is present from the RAM. Hence, the capacity of RAM is much important. Even the configuration of the computer is decided by the capacity of the RAM. So, without this ROM and RAM, no calculator or computer can work.

PROM→Programmable Read Only Memory

This is like a ROM. The purpose of this IC is also the same as ROM. The difference between ROM and PROM is, in PROM we can (a software engineer) store the necessary booting(POST) instruction. But it can be done only once. After that the content cannot be altered, deleted or changed.

EPROM→Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory

The purpose and use of this memory is similar to ROM and PROM. The difference is, the content of this memory can be erased by passing ultra violet rays through a small hole provided on the top surface of the IC. Again it can be re-programmed.

EEPROM→Electrically Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory

This is also same like EPROM. Here the content of this IC can be erased by passing external electrical pulse through a particular pin of the IC. And again it can be re-programmed. From the above, ROM, PROM, EPROM and EEPROM are doing the same work and hence any one can be used in the computer. In majority of recent computers, EPROM is used as Booting IC and RAM is the live memory.

So far, we have seen the purpose and working of internal memory. For your notice, we cannot store anything permanent in this.

9.6.2.2 External Memory

If we want to store anything permanent it can be stored only under external memory. There are few types of external memory.

1. Floppy Disc
2. Hard Disc
3. Magnetic Tape
4. Compact Disc
5. Pen Drive
6. Memory Card

From the above, floppy disc is totally outdated. CD, Hard disc, pen-drive and memory-card are widely used. Let us see about the capacity of these. When we talk about any capacity, it should have its own unit. Normally the unit of memory is 'Byte'. It is better to know about hierarchical structure of it.The memory capacity is mentioned by the following units summarized in Table 9.2.

As like 10 mm = 1 cm.

Approximately 10 Bits = 1 Byte

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